and other tribal communities reside there. The circumambulation of the Narmada signifies a pilgrimage through the life perspective of this tribal community. It involves experiencing interdependence with nature, and understanding and adapting to it. The Bharat Jodo Yatra felt these subtle ecological waves as it reached the Narmada. The journey reached the next phase with the sight of the Narmada, and in the vicinity there was a statue of Tantya Bhil, who sacrificed his life fighting against British colonialism.

An Adivasi public meeting was organized at the memorial site. The BJP government in the state had announced the 'PESA' (Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas) rules to grant rights under the law.[1] The reality behind the shiny propaganda became apparent when the rules were published. The purpose of this law was to provide legal recognition to the traditional collective rights of the Adivasi, make the community a participant in forest and natural resource management, and empower the gram sabha with maximum authority in natural resource management. It also included the selection of beneficiaries in forest produce management and forest rights.

The state government created a commotion under the guise of rules. According to the new regulations, the gram sabha would have only the rights granted under the Madhya Pradesh Panchayat Raj Avam Gram Swaraj Adhiniyam of 1993. In other words, they would not have the traditionally recognized community rights as indicated in the PESA Act of 1996. However, in the state, it has confined itself only to the limits of the panchayat. It remains silent on rules related to forest rights and forest produce collection. The new rules have reduced the gram sabha to a mere implementing agency. Adivasi leaders spoke about all these issues in the jan sabha.

Those who came together included those affected by the privatization of forests, the interference of big corporates, deforestation and exploitation due to diamond mining in Buxwaha, the displacement of the Sahariya tribes for the sake of cheetahs coming from South Africa to the Kuno National Park in Sheopur, the displacement of villagers affected by big dams and the increase in their height. Displaced villagers, such as those from Mandla and Jabalpur, will be affected due to the Chutka Nuclear Power Project. A whole